



redBus **INDIA BUS TRACK**

Intercity Bus Travel Trends in India by
passengers, regions and private operators.

APRIL - SEPTEMBER 2025

OVERVIEW OF INDIAN BUS INDUSTRY

01

Representation of major trends in the Indian bus industry in April-September 2025. This is indicative of all India bus data, it showcases volume and scale across the industry. These estimates pertain to the full intercity bus market derived from the redBus database and do not pertain only to sales on the redBus platforms. This market estimate is restricted to private bus operators and does not include SRTC's (State Road Transport Corporations)

Number of passengers travelling

Number of seats sold in April-September 2025

140.15 Mn

Apr-Sept 2024: 112.47 Mn*

Gross Ticketing Value

Transaction value of all the seats sold in April-September 2025

INR 132.16 Bn

Apr-Sept 2024: 107.18 Bn*

Average seat price

(Gross Ticketing Value/ Total seats)

INR 943

Apr-Sept 2024: INR 953

Active Pvt Bus Operators

Count of bus operators who have sold at least 1 seat in April-September 2025

6073

July-September 2024: 5032

CEO's Quote

In this edition of BusTrack, we have moved from a quarterly to semi-annual format, covering the seasonally lower activity quarter of April-June and the quarter of comparatively higher activity, namely July-September.

The market has grown significantly to 140 million seats sold in April - September this year, compared to 112 million seats sold last year - a solid 25% growth number. This growth has come on the back of existing bus operators adding inventory, new operators starting businesses on traditional routes and digitisation of inventory in long tail and new routes. There has been a big jump in the number of private bus operators coming online, which has led to a significant expansion in the network base in both, towns connected as well as unique bus routes. We also see a clear shift in the preference towards AC buses.

In this edition of the report, the spotlight is on Maharashtra, the largest state for bus travel. Maharashtra sees significant intrastate travel, accounting for 67% of bus travel. The state shows a higher average seat price of Rs. 1066 ; interestingly this is significantly higher than the average price of a ticket pan-India. Maharashtra also shows a healthy bus occupancy of 79%.



- PRAKASH SANGAM

*NOTE: The data published in the July-September edition 2024 for certain metrics accounts only for the first 20 days of September. In this edition of the report, data has been considered for the full period. The number of passengers travelling from July - September 2024 quarter was 52.09 million and the gross ticketing value in the same period was Rs. 49.64 billion.

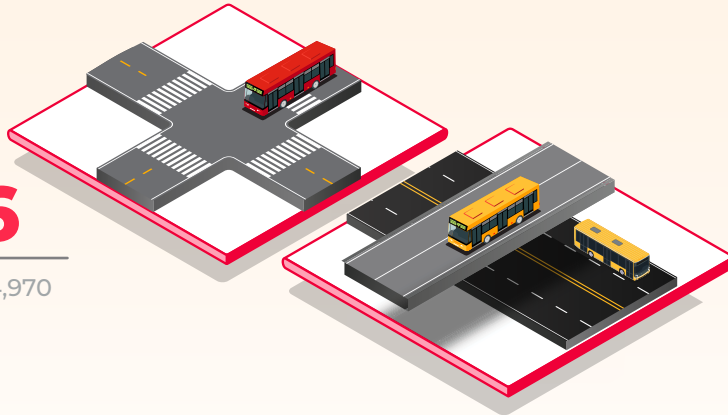
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02

Unique bus routes in India

6,70,346

July-September 2024: 4,94,970



Unique towns connected

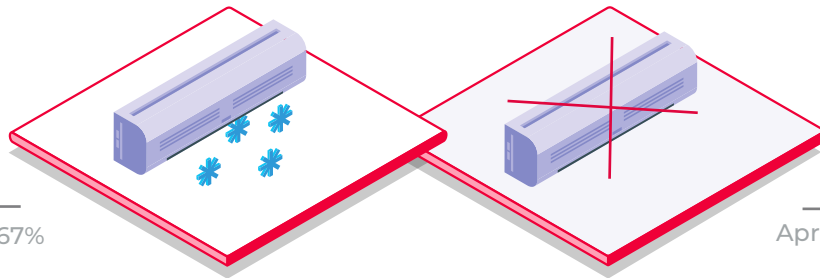
11,177

July-September 2024: 9,977

Journeys split by AC & Non-AC

AC
71%

April-September 2024: 67%

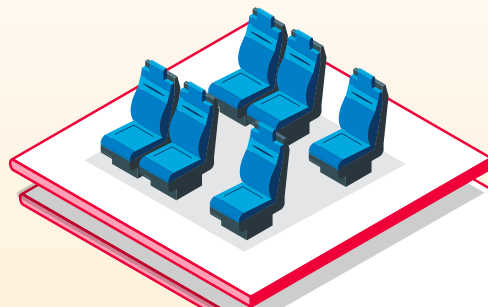


Non-AC
29%

April - September 2024: 33%

Journeys split by bus type

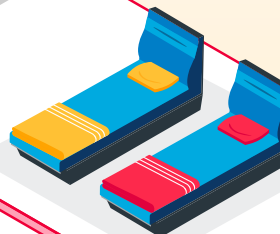
Seater
15%



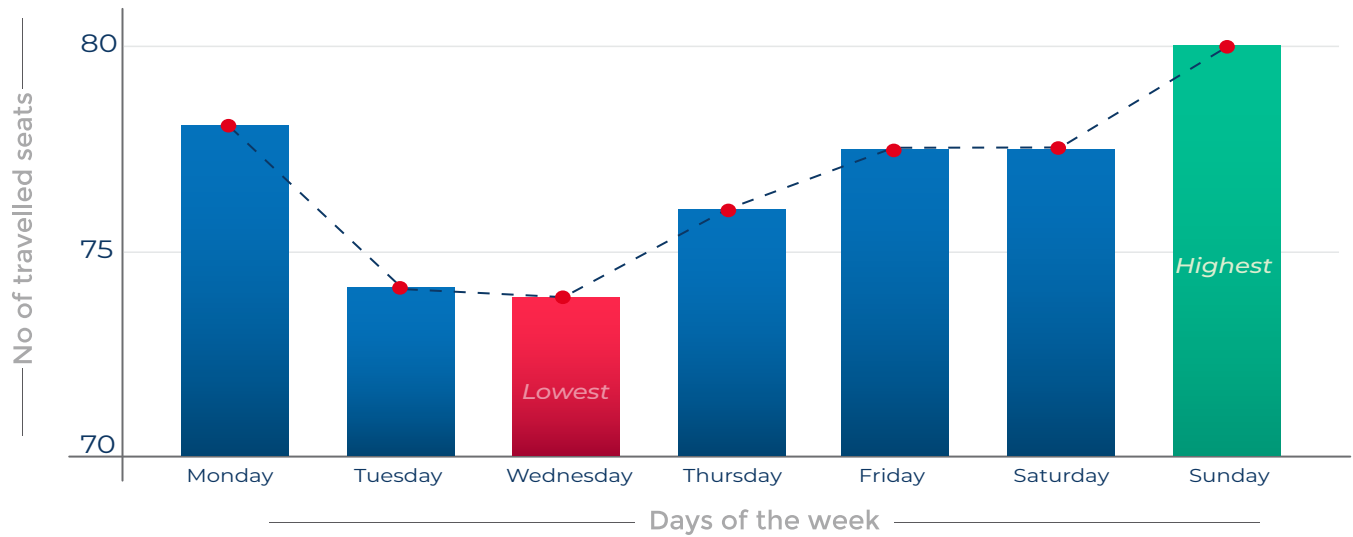
Hybrid
34%



Sleeper
51%



Bus occupancy trends by day of the week



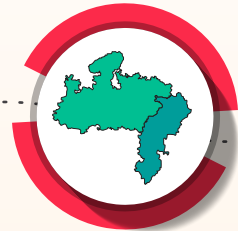
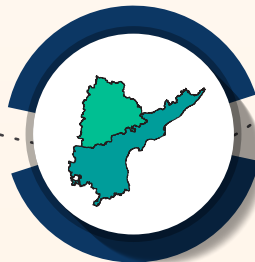
Bus occupancy trends



All India
76%

Andhra Pradesh +
Telangana -
Highest occupancy

84%



Madhya Pradesh
& Chhattisgarh -
Lowest occupancy

63%

Split of routes in India

65%

Long Routes

More than 250 kms

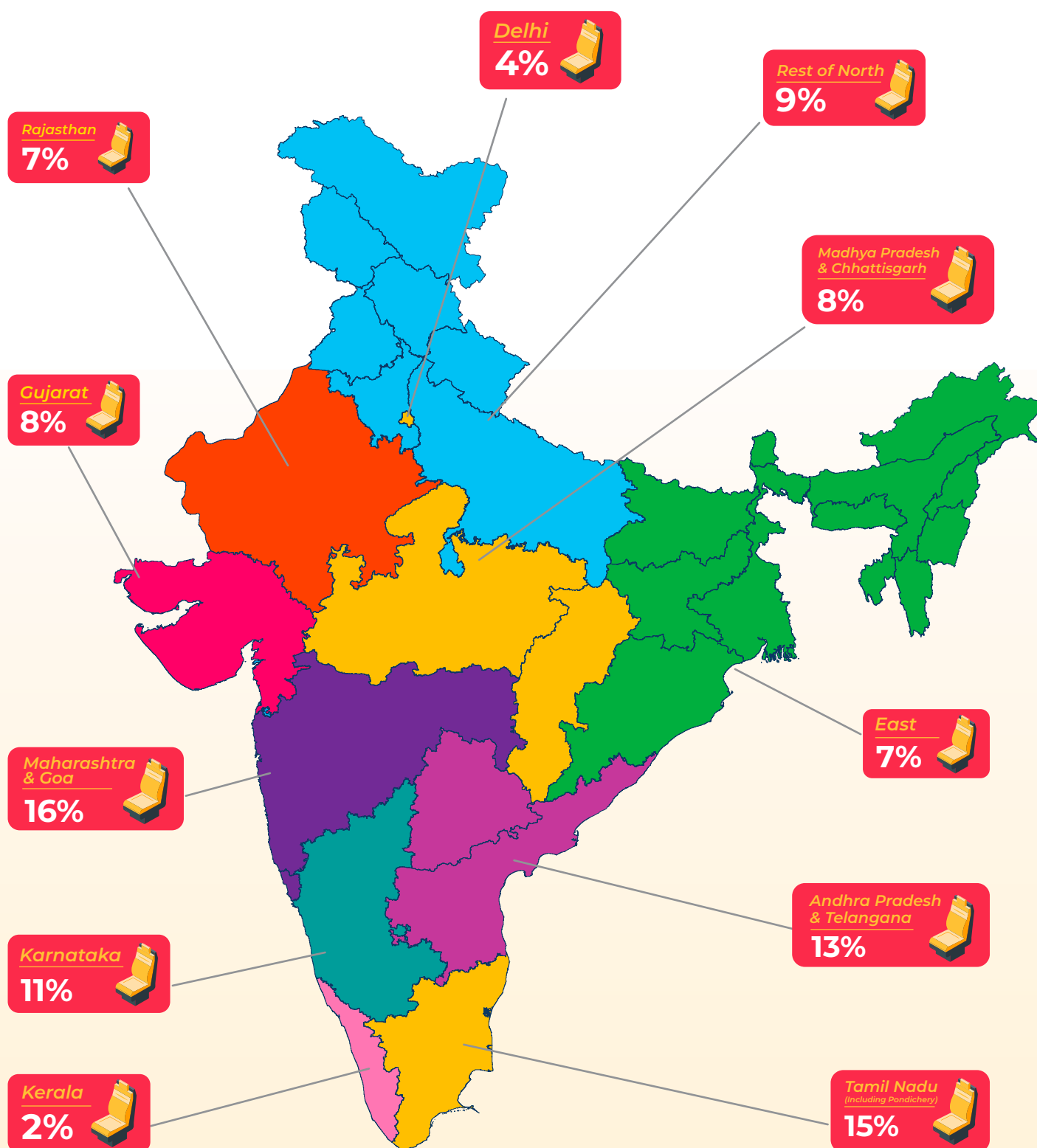
35%

Short Routes

Less than 250 kms

Seats By Region

This page shows a comparison of different regions in terms of bus seat bookings.



North - Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh

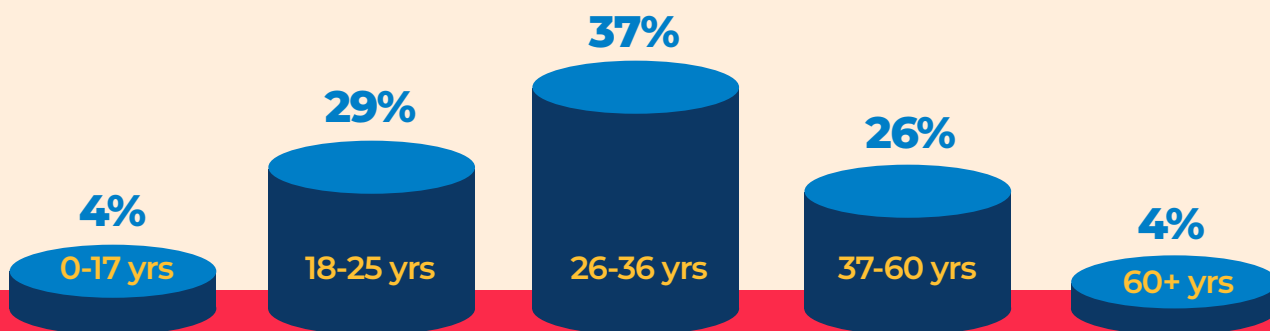
East - Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Nagaland, Manipur, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram, Sikkim, Odisha, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Bihar

PASSENGER TRENDS FOR BOOKINGS THROUGH REDBUS:

05

This section details out how Indians traveled, showcasing dominant demographic trends In April-September 2025. For deeper insights, redBus has highlighted some aspects of its sales. While these approximate overall industry trends, they are not an exact representation.

AGE OF BUS PASSENGERS



Age of passenger(s) traveling

GENDER OF BUS PASSENGERS



Gender of passenger(s) traveling

SINGLE VS. COUPLE VS. GROUP BOOKINGS

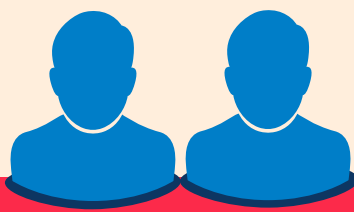
Single Bookings

52%



Couple Bookings

30%



Group Bookings

18%



More than two seats booked is classified as 'Group booking'

GEOGRAPHIC STATISTICS

06

This section details how Indians traveled, showcasing dominant geographic trends in April-September 2025. For deeper insights, redBus has highlighted some aspects of its sales. While these approximate overall industry trends, they are not an exact representation.

From where are people booking buses?

33%

Metros

Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Bangalore, Hyderabad and Kolkata

6%

Other State Capitals

All state capitals and Union Territories other than the 6 Metros

61%

Other Cities

All cities and towns not covered in the above two categories



(redBus data)

State in spotlight:

MAHARASHTRA

07

This page showcases major trends in the Maharashtra bus industry from April-September 2025.

To gain deeper insights, redBus has highlighted some aspects of its sales in Maharashtra; therefore while these approximate overall bus trends in Maharashtra, it is not an exact representation. This estimate is restricted to private bus operators and does not include the State Road Transport Corporation of Maharashtra.

For journeys starting from **Maharashtra**,

- Interstate travel accounts for **33%** of total travel. Some of the most popular interstate travel destinations are Hyderabad, Indore, Bangalore, Goa, Ahmedabad and Surat
- Intrastate accounts for **67%** of total travel. Some of the key intrastate travel destinations are Pune, Mumbai, Nagpur, Kolhapur, Aurangabad, Latur and Nashik

Maharashtra occupancy is **79%**; all India occupancy is 76%

Average ticket price for bus journeys in Maharashtra is **INR 1066**

This is higher than the all India average of INR 943

There was a **75% spike** in travel in Independence Day related travel (August 17), compared to the average travel per day

The top routes (by highest bookings) in **Maharashtra** were:

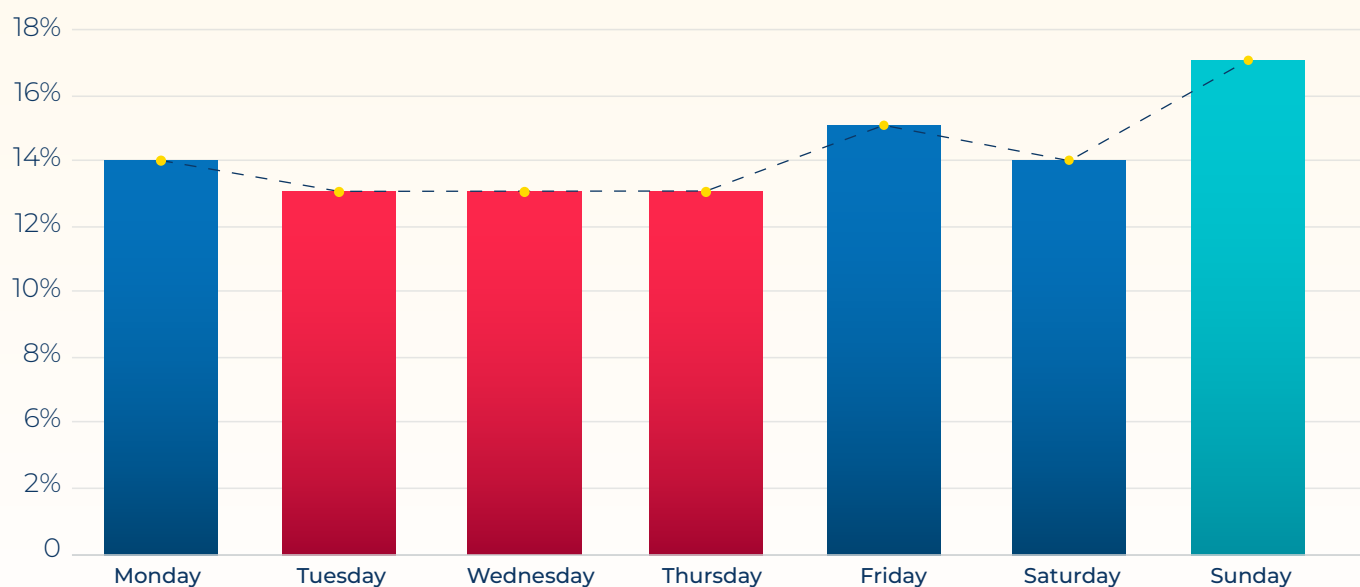
PUNE ⇌ MUMBAI

PUNE ⇌ NAGPUR

PUNE ⇌ HYDERABAD



Bus occupancy rates by days of the week:



Gender break up of bus passengers:

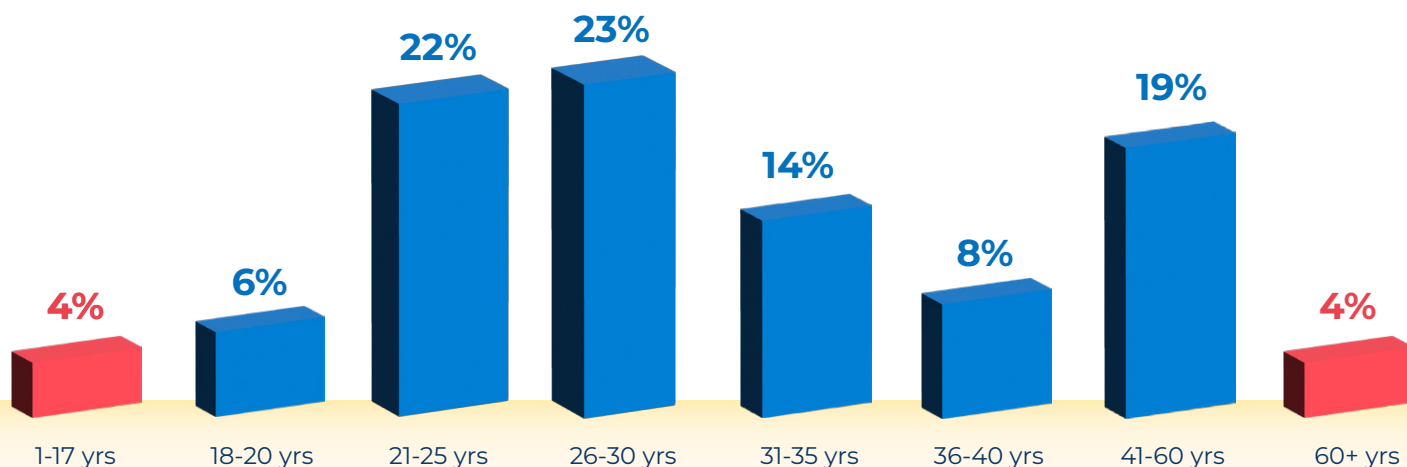


66%
Male



34%
Female

Age breakdown of bus passengers:



ABOUT redBus

redBus was founded in 2006 in India and today is the world's largest Online bus ticketing platform. After having solved the complex problems of bus customers in India, redBus also launched operations in Singapore, Indonesia and Malaysia in 2015 and acquired a majority stake in Peru-based bus ticketing platform Bus portal (now redBus.Pe) in the subsequent year. With this acquisition, redBus successfully launched operations in Latin America markets, Peru & shortly thereafter, Colombia.

In 2023, redBus launched operations in Cambodia and Vietnam. redBus has globally sold more than 466 million bus tickets to date and has a customer base of around 52 million users. redBus is now part of the MakeMyTrip group (NASDAQ, MMYT) which is the largest travel aggregator in India with offerings across categories such as Flights, Hotels, Holiday Packages, etc. The business owns multiple products - Seat Seller, redPro, YourBus, revMax and rise which come together to serve and address the fragmented bus Industry across geographies.

METHODOLOGY

The India Bus Track report is a quarterly property representing the state of the Indian intercity bus market. It showcases overall industry metrics and reflects travel trends across multiple geographies and consumer segments. Calculations pertain to the full intercity bus market estimated and derived from the redBus database and do not pertain to sales on redBus platforms. Scenarios such as blocked seats, offline seats and service inclusions have been accounted for, to ensure that the validity of the data is not compromised and that the report is a highly robust and reliable indicator of intercity bus travel.

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